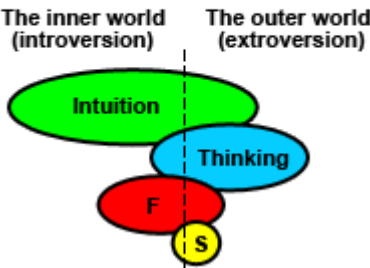


Cognitive Functions

Cognitive functions are the technical term for “Modes of processing information and making decisions based on your Myers-Briggs type.” Each type has four (out of a possible eight) cognitive functions, which they use in a specific order. Identifying which functions you use – and in what order – is the most accurate way to type yourself or anyone else.

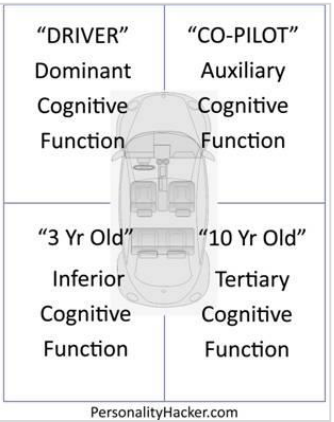
INTJ Functions INTJ Primary Processes



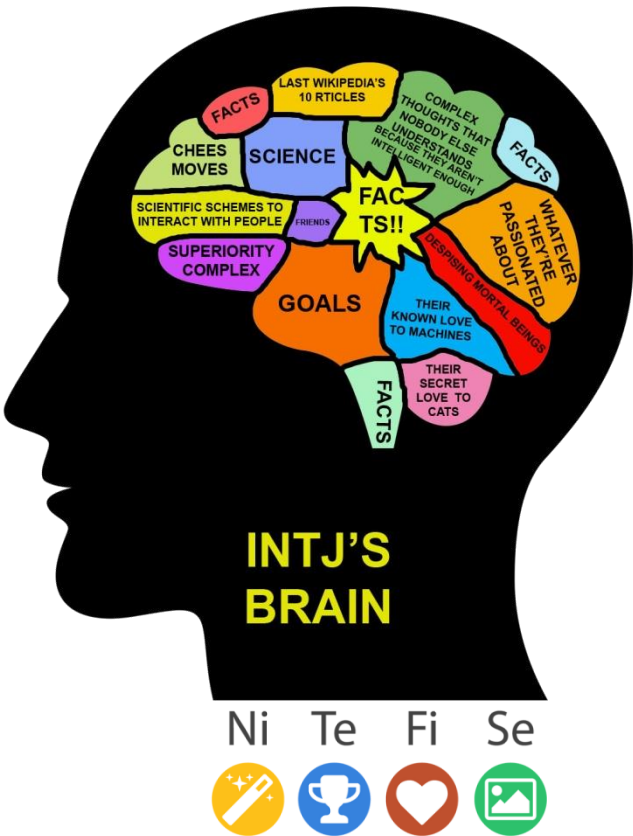
Role	Process	Snapshot
Leading “Driver”	Introverted iNtuition	Foreseeing implications, transformations, and likely effects.
Supportive “Co-Pilot”	Extroverted Thinking	Segmenting, organising for efficiency, and systematising.
Relief “10 year old”	Introverted Feeling	Valuing and considering importance, beliefs, and worth.
Aspirational “3 year old”	Extroverted Sensing	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context.

The analogy of a car is a useful model when thinking about cognitive functions. The first function is the ‘driver’ of the personality type and is the function from which perspective of all of the other functions follow. It provides the direction and speed. The second function is the ‘co-pilot’, which navigates around or through any difficulties encountered. The inferior, or 3 year old, function attempts to distract both primary and secondary functions whereas the tertiary function, or ‘10 year old’, only distracts the current dominant function.

Understanding cognitive functions is imperative to understanding type. The four-letter dichotomies cannot possibly explain the complexity of our personalities – we are all thinkers, feelers, sensors and intuitives in various situations. The cognitive functions allow us to understand when we use each function and how it impacts our decision-making process.



The Cognitive Functions



Role	Process	Snapshot
Ne	Extroverted Intuition	How do concepts happen outside me?
Ni	Introverted Intuition	How do concepts happen within me?
Fe	Extroverted Feeling	How does this make others feel?
Fi	Introverted Feeling	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context.
Te	Extroverted Thinking	How does this logically affect things?
Ti	Introverted Thinking	How does this logically affect me?
Se	Extroverted Sensing	How is the environment outside me?
Si	Introverted Sensing	How is the environment inside me?

CONCLUSION

INTJ Strategists are gifted theorists. They thrive on understanding and formulating complex systems. Of all the personality types, INTJs are the most penetrating in thought and insight.

Their greatest contribution is their desire to produce mastery and achievement that reflects their brilliance.



What is MBTI?

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) is a tool that helps people gain insights about themselves and how they interact with others—and improve how they communicate, learn, and work.

Often referred to as a ‘personality test’, MBTI actually has less to do with one’s personality and everything to do with how their brain works from receiving and processing external information to communication preferences. These preferences are split into four pairs – I/E, S/N, F/T and J/P. Though everyone is unique and will have some traits of all 8 letters, people will often be more inclined towards one letter in each pair. By determining your preference in each group, and putting these four letters together, you get your personality **type code** – for you, this is **INTJ**.

INTJ – The Mastermind

What does that mean?

Introverted	Energised by quiet time alone
iNtuitive	Sees patterns and possibilities
Thinking	Prioritises logic and reason
Judging	Prefers structure and order

Often intellectual, INTJs are analytical problem-solvers who enjoy logical reasoning and complex problem-solving. They have innovative ideas and an aptitude for seeing possibilities for improvement, whether at work, at home, or in themselves.



INTJs are approach life by analysing the theory behind what they see, and are typically focused inward, on their own thoughtful study of the world around them. INTJs are drawn to logical systems and are much less comfortable with the unpredictable nature of other people and their emotions. They are typically independent and selective about their relationships, preferring to associate with people who they find intellectually stimulating. Objective and logical, they are critical, impersonal and thick-skinned. INTJs are structured and scheduled. They are controlled and responsible. They seek closure and enjoy completing tasks.

INTJs are Thinkers that make decisions with their head. Their talents lie in defining goals, creating detailed plans, and outlining contingencies. INTJs thrive on putting theories to work and are open to any and all ideas that can be integrated into the complex systems they seek to understand.

Strengths

- Quick, Imaginative and Strategic Mind – INTJs pride themselves on their minds, taking every opportunity to improve their knowledge.
- High Self-Confidence – INTJs trust their rationalism above all else, and have an honest, direct style of communication that isn’t held back by perceived social roles or expectations.
- Independent and Decisive – This creativity, logic and confidence come together to form individuals who stand on their own and take responsibility for their own actions.
- Hard-working and determined – If something piques their interest, INTJs can be astonishingly dedicated to their work, putting in long hours and intense effort to see an idea through.
- Open-minded – INTJ’s rationalism leads to a very intellectually receptive personality type that remain open to new ideas, supported by logic
- Jacks-of-all-Trades – Open-mindedness, determination, independence, confidence and strategic abilities create individuals who are capable of doing anything they set their minds to.

Weaknesses

- Arrogant – INTJs are perfectly capable of carrying their confidence too far and can be brutally insensitive in making their opinions of others all too clear.
- Judgmental – INTJs tend to have complete confidence in their thought process, dismissing other ideas and their proponents as stuck in some baser mode of thought.
- Overly analytical – Their analytical prowess can fall painfully short where logic doesn’t rule – such as with human relationships.
- Loathe highly structured environments – Hold disdain for blindly following precedents and rules without understanding for authority figures who blindly uphold those laws and rules without understanding their intent.
- Clueless in romance – This antipathy to rules and tendency to over-analyse and be judgmental adds up to a personality type that is often clueless in dating.



Although not usually warm or particularly gregarious, INTJs tend to have a self-assured manner with people based on their own security in their intelligence. They relate their ideas with confidence, and once they have arrived at a conclusion they fully expect others to see the wisdom in their perceptions. They are typically perfectionists and appreciate an environment of intellectual challenge. They enjoy discussing interesting ideas, and may get themselves into trouble because of their take-no-prisoners attitude: if someone's beliefs don't make logical sense, the Mastermind typically has no qualms about pointing that out.



- Dwight D. Eisenhower, *American President*
- Thomas Jefferson, *American President*
- Augustus Caesar, *Roman Emperor*
- Sir Isaac Newton, *Astronomer*
- Susan B. Anthony, *Civil Rights Leader*
- Peter Jennings, *Journalist*
- C. S. Lewis, *Apologist, Author*
- Arnold Schwarzenegger, *Actor, Calif. Governor*



As managers: INTJs make natural leaders, valuing innovation and effectiveness more than most other qualities. They will gladly cast aside hierarchy, protocol and even their own beliefs if they are presented with rational arguments about why things should change. Promoting freedom and flexibility in the workplace, efficiency and results are king to INTJs, and behaviours that undermine these conditions are quashed mercilessly.

Career Matches

- Systems Analyst
- Computer Programmer
- Entrepreneur
- Computer Specialist
- Engineer
- Corporate Strategist
- Researcher
- Scientist
- Medical Doctor
- Lawyer/Attorney
- Professor
- Psychologist
- Business Administrator
- Military Officer
- Manager
- Judge
- Teacher
- Organisation Founder
- Dentist

Popular INTJ hobbies

- Reading
- Cultural events
- Taking classes
- Appreciating art
- Computers and video games
- Independent sports
 - Swimming
 - Backpacking
 - running marathons



Game of Thrones:



Disney:



INTJs may have more success in developing friendships than romantic relationships, as they tend to substitute rational processes for emotional availability. Overcoming these hurdles is often all but impossible without the sort of instant connection made possible by sharing the Intuitive (N) trait.

Kindred spirits:

ISJT, INTP, ENTJ

Intriguing differences:

INFP, INFJ, ENTP, ENFJ

ISFP, ISFJ, ESFP and ESFJ personalities can clash and conflict with the INTJ, but may also offer the best opportunities for growth. With fundamentally different values and motivations, their strengths are the INTJ's weaknesses, and if they are able to develop a relationship, they can learn a tremendous amount from each other.



- they have gone too long expecting far too much from themselves.

INTJs are great at accomplishing their goals, but will never truly feel like they have grown enough, or become successful enough.

When the INTJ has gone too long with these rather overwhelming expectations, they may experience a sense of apathy. Instead of their normally driven and clever selves, the INTJ will become self-indulgent and avoidant. They won't be focused on getting things done, and might become self-destructive. The INTJ simply needs to take a look at their accomplishments, and realise that they have actually succeeded in a lot. They are smart enough to realise that no one can be perfect, so why should they expect this from themselves?



disorganized work environment

PROCRASTINATION shortsightedness

not having a goal in mind

INTJ

INDECISION

talk about our feelings

DISMISSING MY LOGICAL DECISIONS

LACK OF INITIATIVE

challenging my competence micromanaging

LIMITED TIME TO CHANGE PLANS

mindless rule followers

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Change

INTJs often analyse the change in an attempt to figure out what sort of affects it will have. They want to find out if this is a good or bad change, and how they should be reacting to it. INTJs are open to evolving and growing themselves as they witness changes in their environment, they are often skilled at adapting. INTJs do enjoy having enough notice to be able to navigate the change ahead of them, since they enjoy being able to keep things controlled. Their strong sense of intuition often makes them capable of seeing the change around the corner.



INTJ
Come in, but kindly leave your touchy-feely at the door